

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



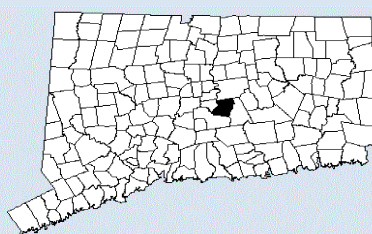
Portland School District

Charles Britton, Superintendent • 860-342-6790 • <http://www.portlandctschoools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	6
Enrollment	1,243
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$20,901
Total Expenditures ¹	\$26,544,597

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	651	52.4	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.2
Asian	17	1.4	5.2
Black or African American	52	4.2	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	217	17.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	62	5.0	4.7
White	895	72.0	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	44	3.5	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	372	29.9	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	268	21.6	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	98	15.4	50	7.4
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	20	40.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	49	23.1	21	9.1
White	102	11.9	30	3.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	17	34.7	6	11.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	101	28.9	41	9.8
Students with Disabilities	70	27.6	33	10.8
District	180	15.1	65	5.1
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 52

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	93.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	1.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	21.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	53.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	4.3
School Level	6.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	4.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	2.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	12.0
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	57.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	1	0.7	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	0.7	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	143	98.6	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	14.8	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	*	11	*
White	58	95.1	55	100.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	15	*	17	85.0
Students with Disabilities	12	*	8	*
District	76	91.6	70	95.9
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	14	53.8
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	75	78.1
Other Health Impairment	37	55.2
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	24	92.3
District	155	65.1
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	29	2.4	2.6
Emotional Disability	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	96	7.8	6.4
Other Health Impairment	67	5.4	3.5
Other Disabilities	18	1.5	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	31	2.5	2.0
All Disabilities	253	20.6	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	10	4.0	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	18	7.1	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$15,839,303	\$12,472	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$1,730,969	\$1,405	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$914,572	\$742	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,144,746	\$929	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$1,804,331	\$1,465	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$449,260	\$365	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$2,954,521	\$2,398	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$1,306,125	\$1,256	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$400,770	\$325	\$213
Total	\$26,544,597	\$20,901	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,878,523	28.1	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$696,717	10.4	10.2
Other Salaries	\$657,427	9.8	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$940,288	14.1	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$546,688	8.2	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,369,143	20.5	22.2
Supplies	\$44,279	0.7	0.7
Property Services	\$19	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$534,330	8.0	8.4
Equipment	\$10,720	0.2	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$6,678,134	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		25.2	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	71.9
State	22.2
Federal	5.7
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	10	*	10	*	*	*
Black or African American	26	53.0	26	46.0	13	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	129	61.0	128	55.5	47	58.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	33	72.7	33	65.2	*	*
White	480	75.4	479	71.9	211	70.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	44	54.6	44	50.2	14	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	634	73.0	632	68.8	268	68.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	189	59.3	187	53.3	70	54.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	489	76.7	489	73.1	212	71.3
Students with Disabilities	147	49.6	146	45.1	52	45.1
Students without Disabilities	531	78.0	530	73.8	230	72.1
High Needs	273	58.1	271	53.1	102	53.5
Non-High Needs	405	81.1	405	77.3	180	74.8
District	678	71.8	676	67.6	282	67.1

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	87.4	99.1	94.1	82.3	399	91.2
Curl Up	76.6	100.0	86.3	74.7	399	85.0
Push Up	73.6	92.5	88.3	73.4	398	82.4
Mile Run/PACER	76.9	97.2	76.7	41.8	396	75.3
All Tests - District	65.7	92.5	63.7	39.2	395	67.1
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	*
White	59	89.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	22	68.2
Students with Disabilities	14	*
District	82	85.4
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	39	49.4
Male	34	44.7
Non-Binary	0	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	9	33.3
White	61	52.6
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	11	28.2
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	73	46.8
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	94.3	95.5
Male	83.3	92.9
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	96.2	96.7
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	88.7	94.4
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	71.8	75	47.9	50	95.8	63.9
	High Needs Students	58.1	75	38.8	50	77.5	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	67.6	75	45.1	50	90.2	60.2
	High Needs Students	53.1	75	35.4	50	70.9	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	67.1	75	44.7	50	89.5	61.8
	High Needs Students	53.5	75	35.7	50	71.4	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	66.9%	100%	66.9	100	66.9	58.7%
	High Needs Students	64.0%	100%	64.0	100	64.0	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	62.6%	100%	62.6	100	62.6	61.4%
	High Needs Students	51.9%	100%	51.9	100	51.9	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	71.5%	100%	35.8	50	71.5	58.9%
	Oral	49.9%	100%	24.9	50	49.9	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	15.1%	<=5%	29.9	50	59.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	25.6%	<=5%	8.9	50	17.7	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	93.6%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	46.8%	75%	31.2	50	62.4	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		86.9%	94%	46.2	50	92.5	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		85.4%	94%	90.8	100	90.8	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		88.5%	94%	94.1	100	94.1	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		88.7%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		96.8% 67.1%	75%	44.7	50	89.5	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		64.4%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1099.5	1450	75.8	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.1	16.9	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	53.1	21.9	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	74.8	53.5	21.3	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.5%	5.5%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.3
	High Needs Students	97.6
Math	All Students	98.0
	High Needs Students	96.9
Science	All Students	97.9
	High Needs Students	96.4

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Over the past several years, including the 2023-24 school year, Portland Public Schools has extensively strengthened our special education services and multi-tiered systems of support for students with disabilities across the district. We have fully implemented within each of our five school buildings district-developed therapeutic alternative day programs that have significantly reduced the need for special education outplacements. Through these programs, which are collaboratively staffed by district-employed educators and clinicians, we are able to keep our higher-needs students in-district with their community peers and, in doing so, offer them targeted supports and services with continued access to our tier I district curricula.

The district has a full-time applied behavior analyst who provides services to students in need and collaborates with classroom staff to continually strengthen behavior management and social emotional instruction for all students. Each of our five schools is staffed with a full time social worker, a full time school psychologist, and full complement of special education teachers and paraprofessionals based on student needs. School counselors support our middle and high school students. The district continues to make strategic use of consultative services to provide professional development and guidance to all staff on research-based best practices in behavioral science. The focus of this work has been on trauma-informed instruction and high-leverage strategies for meeting the social emotional needs of all students with emphasis on high-needs learners. The efforts described above have helped us to continually improve our comprehensive array of support services, which enable our students with disabilities to meet success within least restrictive environments across Portland Public Schools.

Portland Public schools actively monitors student attendance and strategically intervenes when patterns of absence interfere with a students' social, academic, and personal success. Such interventions occur most specifically when a student is on track to miss more than four days of school in a single calendar month or ten school days for the entire year. Throughout the district, we have strong response/support processes and protocols in place that school counselors, social workers, teachers, and administrators use to develop specific, measurable support plans that promote student attendance. To further support high levels of student attendance and engagement, each of our five buildings maintains a school climate committee that strives to create a positive school climate inclusive, inviting, and supportive of all students. The district continues to make significant strides in reducing instances of discipline, suspension, and expulsion through the use of restorative practices and a focus on building and preserving positive, healthy relationships. Portland Public Schools has trained all secondary staff on the use of restorative practices to promote stronger relationships.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Portland Public Schools actively participates in state-wide and locally-offered programs that promote and sustain diversity, equity, and inclusion. In 2023-24, approximately 70 students who reside in Hartford attended Portland Public Schools via the Open Choice program. Additionally, we had many secondary students participate in courses offered by Connecticut's Virtual High School program.

Portland Public Schools maintains a teacher recruitment and retention plan that strives to employ diverse and talented staff within our schools. Diverse teacher recruitment is a critical component of our plan. To support these efforts, Portland Public Schools maintains a strategic partnership with TEACH Connecticut, a platform designed to guide and inform aspiring educators towards public school employment within the state. Portland Public Schools is a featured community on the TEACH Connecticut website. Additionally, our district regularly participates in local teacher recruitment fairs, including those offered by area universities and an annual minority teacher recruitment fair hosted by the Capitol Region Education Council (CREC). Diverse candidates we meet via fairs and through our strategic partnerships with organizations such as TEACH Connecticut are given priority consideration within our hiring processes. Portland is actively looking to expand our teacher recruitment efforts into the future and in coordination with state efforts to increase representation in the field for teachers of color.

Portland Public Schools offers all students PreK-12 robust curricula that prioritizes inclusivity for all and representation of historically underrepresented groups. Social justice is a critical component of social studies and language arts coursework and related content. Students wrestle with essential questions and emerge with enduring understandings associated with our nation's and the world's ongoing struggles against forces of racism, discrimination, intolerance, and inhumanity. Through class discourse, experiential and project-based learning, and inquiry-based research, students are invited to identify challenges of inequity and injustice and to take informed action to make our community, state, nation, and world a better and more just place for all.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Portland Public Schools ensures the equitable allocation of resources among district schools through a collaborative budget development process that engages a wide variety of community representatives. Each school receives a baseline per pupil expenditure that ensures funds are distributed equitably. Each school and department is also provided the opportunity to advocate for funding to support school improvement initiatives. District leaders, building principals, team leaders, and curriculum specialists work collaboratively to prioritize resources and maximize the benefit of district funds. The funding priorities are then vetted by the Portland Board of Education, and ultimately are subject to community approval through the referendum process.

In addition to the regular budgeting process, supplemental funding exists through several grant programs, including the Perkins Grant, Gildersleeve Wheeler Grant, Ryan Fund, Title grants, and other opportunities. Portland utilizes all sources of grant funding at our disposal to obtain and equitably allocate resources across our schools and in service to all learners.